WORKSHOP HANDOUT

Putting self-interest to work for the public good

An application of the Decentralized Curation framework

Institute of Open Science Practices (IOSP) 2026, Leiden · Wednesday 14 October 2026, 14:00 to 15:20

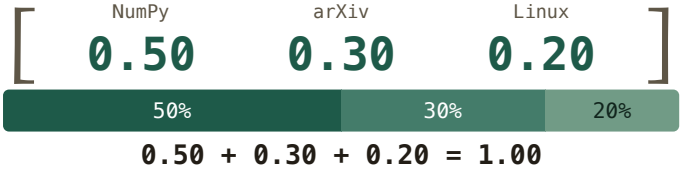
Who judges what matters?

Decentralized Curation aims to make honesty, competence and scrutiny personally rewarding, so pursuing personal benefit can also create public benefit. It seeks credible consensus without having to trust each juror individually or requiring permission to take part. This handout explores one application of the framework: checking testable claims and judging public goods against a stated goal.

Curating public goods

1. **Define the goal and criteria.** Specify required evidence and assessor rewards.
2. **Nominate work.** Anyone can submit claims and evidence with a deposit.
3. **Judge relevance.** People put down a deposit to enter the draw for paid jury work. Selected jurors score independently using the criteria and risk penalties for large disagreements with the final judgment.
4. **Appeal a score.** Competing, fully funded proposals trigger a larger jury; anyone can contribute.
5. **Reassess periodically.** Run fresh scoring rounds.
6. **Publish the assessment.** Show how much each eligible contribution matters relative to the others.
7. **Challenge claims at any time.** Anyone can challenge an active nomination's claims. An external arbitrator decides. If a claim is false or untestable, the fact-checker receives the submitter's deposit and the nomination ends. The submitter can nominate again.

Crowd curation produces relative weights



0.50 + 0.30 + 0.20 = 1.00

These example weights sum to one and reflect judgments under the chosen criteria, not measured public benefit. Funding is one possible use.

One example: research infrastructure

How much does this nominee's completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

Consider 1	Consider 2	Consider 3
how many rely	role in research	other options

0.00	not infrastructure
0.25	matters to one field
0.50	relied on in several fields
0.75	widely relied on
1.00	critical across research

Honesty, competence and scrutiny

Honesty: report sincerely.

Competence: know how to judge it.

Scrutiny: critically examine claims and evidence.

Honesty and scrutiny do not replace expertise.

Fees pay for assessment. Jurors score privately; coherence is rewarded and incoherence penalized. The game aims to make honest assessment the shared focal point: a Schelling point. Agreement alone does not establish good judgment. Competition can favor competence only if informed judgment pays better, after costs, than predicting others' answers. Underperformers can lose influence unless they replenish their stake.

Try

Scoring workshop

Try the game: make your own judgment, then see what the incentives reward.

Read

Framework preprint

Stay in touch

Mailing list

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Decentralized Curation research by Ferit Tunçer.

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